

Breach Below Bergum



Adventure Background

Bergum started as nothing more than a pit-stop along the river line, a place for trains to cool their boilers and for attendants to stretch their legs. Twenty years ago, a curious worker slipped off the embankment and straight into the richest vein of silver the entire kingdom had seen in a generation. Overnight, Bergum was transformed. The newly established Bergum Mining Guild poured in labor, equipment, and coin, carving a thriving town out of the dusty riverbed.

But fortunes fade. The silver thinned, then dwindled, and now the guild has already shifted most of its operations to richer ground. Only a skeleton crew remains to clear the last tunnels and shutter the site for good.

Last week, during that routine cleanup, one of those miners broke through an unstable wall and stumbled into an ancient stone shrine buried beneath the lowest shaft. Something ancient and unknown inside the chamber was disturbed. Apparitions spilled out into Bergum like cold smoke, harassing townsfolk and rattling the sheriff's already strained deputies.

Clearly out of his depth, the sheriff sent word to the nearest city for backup. In response, the Ministry of Obscure Affairs sent their nearest detectives.

Chapter 1: Into the Crypt

To get started, read or paraphrase the following

The mischief of Bergum fades out above you as you enter the lower shaft behind the Sheriff. It's quiet in a way you might expect of a cold dank cave, but all scattered around are the remnants of quite a commotion. Discarded picks and shovels sit silently against the rock, joined by ousted lanterns that have already seen their final flames.

As you branch off of the main tunnels into a cramped, fresh alcove, the Sheriff stops abruptly, hangs his lantern on a thick steel hook, and beckons you close.

"Alright. Breach is right around this corner. The whole shaft's been empty since the night it opened. Barely anyone'll set foot down here last few days, and I don't blame 'em. Can't say I'm too confident you'll be able to seal this up, but I guess you're all we've got right now. You handle what's in there, and I'll keep things from fallin' apart topside."

He lights a fresh torch and heads back up the way you came.

If the players are new to Pathfinder, take this time to allow them to introduce their characters to one another and become familiar with how their characters are supposed to work. You can also provide some light roleplaying before the PCs move on to begin their adventure. The sheriff and his deputies have been working overtime to prevent curious eyes from adding to their list of bodies so this will be the first time anyone has entered the tomb willingly. Nobody else has any useful information to offer about what challenges might lie ahead.

A1. Entrance

The tunnel ends abruptly at a wall of collapsed rubble—the site of the miners' catastrophic mistake. As you scramble into the opening, the cramped tunnel gives way to a massive, cavernous hall of the dead. The air is stagnant and carries a tang that tastes like cave moss and a thousand years of decay.

Dozens of stone sarcophagi line the floor, but the peace of this place has been shattered. The mining tremors have cracked the seals on many of the tombs, and a faint, cold mist seems to drift from the open caskets, confirming this as the source of the town's haunting. Across the expanse of stone and shadow, a single narrow door stands ajar, leading further down into the darkness.

A2. Disturbed Burial

While many caskets lie undisturbed, the collapse of the mine wall dealt a glancing blow to one sarcophagus near the entrance. DC 15 Seek to identify the cracked sarcophagus

It didn't crumble like the wall, but a jagged, spiderweb fracture runs down its side. Through the fissure, you can hear a faint, dry scratching sound—like fingernails on stone.

Hazard

Entombed Spirit

Casket Cover

AC: 15 / Hardness: 5

DC 18 Athletics to move

Reward

Players that break open the tomb, either before or during the encounter, find a blue gem on the corpse.

Embedded in a shattered amulet setting is a fist-sized, deep blue crystal, crisscrossed with pale fractures. It feels unnaturally cold and pulses faintly.

A3. Dusty Hallway

Pushing through the narrow door, the atmosphere instantly changes from the vault-like crypt to a choking hallway. The stone walls here are slick with humidity, and the ceiling presses low overhead. Both sides of the passage are lined with deep, dusty alcoves holding dozens of funerary urns—some clay, some bronze—all covered in a thick layer of soot and dust.

A player that reaches into one of the larger urns on the north side triggers the Hampering Web, as a swarm of spiders emerges from the urn.

Hazards

Hampering Web

Creatures

Spider Swarm

Reward

48 gold
Mistform Elixir (Lesser)
Feather Token (Bird)

A4. Collapsed Wall

The hallway curves ahead into pitch darkness, but to your right, a precarious mound of collapsed rubble has opened a section of the wall, offering a dangerous path up and over the wreckage into another chamber.

To climb the wreckage:

Athletics: Climb (DC 8)

At the top, to handle shifting debris:

Acrobatics: Balance (DC 12)

Three total failures across these checks will seal the passage for the remainder of the party.

A5. Dark Hallway

The hallway continues forward, narrow and draped in complete darkness. The smooth stone walls are cool and damp, torchlight long faded.

As the first player enters the hallway past the collapsed wall, they're afflicted with Phantom Footsteps.

As they approach the corner, if they don't have darkvision they trip over a skeleton and notice a glint and trigger Pit of Toil.

If they have darkvision or a torch they must seek the skeleton to find the gem.

Hazards

[Phantom Footsteps](#)

[Pit of Toil](#)

Reward

Clutched in the skeleton's decrepit hand is a heavy, crimson crystal. Even in the darkness, it holds a faint, deep red internal glimmer.

A6. Treasure Room

Along the western wall of the Atrium, a ten-foot section of smooth, unadorned stone appears perfectly seamless. An exceptionally observant eye might notice the flaw in the otherwise flawless masonry: near the center, one small stone block protrudes by barely a finger-width, betrayed by a thin ridge of settled dust on its edge.

Pushing this stone causes a low, tremendous grinding shudder to pass through the floor of the Atrium. With a heavy, rasping sound, the ten-foot section of wall slides slowly back into the darkness, revealing a small, dry chamber where torchlight immediately catches the intense gleam of gold and treasures within.

Reward

Inside the main chest, among a pile of gold, is the third and final yellow-amber crystal the size of a fist. It has a slightly clouded appearance, with tiny, immobile motes of black dust trapped within its core.

300 gold

[Iron Cube](#)

[Traveler's Any-Tool](#)

[2x Elixir of Life \(Lesser\)](#)

A7. Atrium

The cramped passage gives way to the Atrium, a large, square chamber built with impressive, vaulted stone. The room feels grand and solemn, dominated by the watchful presence of its guardians: stone gargoyles are set into the walls at regular intervals on all four sides, staring down with vacant, malevolent eyes.

Along the far wall, a high mound of rubble reveals the other side of the earlier cave in (and any party members caught on this side of the trap rush to meet you).

Dominating the eastern wall is an elaborate door of massive, granite slabs carved with complex, forgotten runes, beside which sits a heavy, prominent stone lever.

DC 5 Secret Perception check to notice the crystal socket above the lever, seemingly 3 spots for particularly shaped, fist-sized objects.

If players pull the lever to open the door without placing all three crystals in their slots, either by not noticing the socket, or not collecting all of the crystals, 4 of the gargoyles around the room are activated. Upon their defeat, the door opens.

If all three crystals are placed in the slot, the gargoyles crumble to dust and the door opens.

Creatures

4x Gargoyle

Chapter 2: Grand Mausoleum

Big stone door opens, catching and grinding over the eons of dust and bone. The room beyond is slowly revealed by the dim light from the room behind you, and seems devoid of the dust and decay you find yourselves accustomed to down here. Your first steps into the room echo throughout a chamber much larger than the one you were just in, and just as your eyes begin to adjust to the dark, crystal blue braziers crackle to life through the hall revealing the full grandeur of the marble mausoleum. Great pillars line the center of the hall, and at the far end a few short stairs lead up to a pristine marble sarcophagus.

B1. Ultimate Showdown

1. Party enters room, approaches the casket, touches it
2. A non-damaging activation wave fires, anyone who's not in sight of the casket isn't hit (hopefully cluing them into that mechanic. 5 minions scurry down from various columns
3. Roll initiative
4. As the minions are cleared their energy is transferred to torches above the casket in the back. AT THE TOP OF THE ROUND, IF ALL THREE ARE LIT, the casket is immune until the end of the round when it casts its wave attack and summons more minions (optional third attack activating and reconfiguring the traps in the room)
5. When it does this, a magical lock falls away from the casket dispersing into aether
6. When all of the locks are released, big bad boy emerges from the casket
7. All mechanics continue except the creature can now be killed, wave attack moves with him instead of centered on casket
8. go team

Creatures

Hryngar Retainer ([Clockwork Fabricator](#))

Reanimated Hryngar Runelord ([Hryngar Forgepriest](#))

Hazards

Boulder Roll (Custom),
basically Stonecaster's
spell

Reward

Deputy Wade

Gunslinger 5

Versatile Human

Deputy Wade is a fixture of Bergum, having arrived twenty years ago during the peak of the silver fever. He's one of the few who stayed when the mines began to thin out, primarily because he's too stubborn to admit the easy money is gone. He relies on the quick hands and sharp eyes he developed over the years—first tracking claim jumpers and then reluctantly enforcing the Sheriff's strained law.

Wade views the current crisis with the Apparitions spilling from the ancient shrine not as a supernatural mystery, but as a severe target prioritization problem. His solution to nearly every issue is to apply maximum pressure and the largest caliber of ordnance he can shoulder. He is utterly without fear, which the townsfolk usually confuse for genuine bravery.

This combination of relentless enthusiasm and a singular focus on overwhelming firepower is precisely why the Sheriff chose him as backup for the Ministry's investigators. Wade

is the highly motivated local expert the Sheriff is most willing to gamble with, hoping his foolhardiness will either result in a quick solution or, at the very least, keep the most destructive deputy occupied outside of town limits.



Medium	Human	Versatile Human	Humanoid
Perception +11;			
Languages Common			
Skills Acrobatics +13, Athletics +1, Lore: Hunting +9, Performance +9, Society +9, Stealth +11, Survival +9, Thievery +13			
Str +1, Dex +4, Con +2, Int +2, Wis +2, Cha +2			
Items Leather			
AC 22; Fort +11, Ref +13, Will +11			
HP 58			
Hit the Dirt! ➔			
Speed 25 feet			
Ranged Barricade Buster +15 (Uncommon, Kickback, Orc, Razing, Repeating, Volley 20 Ft.), Damage 1d10+1 B			
Cover Fire ⚡			
Running Reload ⚡			
Covered Reload ⚡			
One Shot, One Kill ⚡			
Precision Damage One Shot, One Kill 1d6			
Additional Feats Assurance, Dubious Knowledge, Experienced Tracker, Haughty Obstinacy, Thorough Search, Tumbling			
Teamwork, Unconventional Weaponry			
Additional Specials Assurance (Athletics), Gunslinger Weapon Mastery, Gunslinger's Way (Way of the Sniper), Slinger's Precision, Stubborn, Unconventional Weapon (Barricade Buster)			

Seamus isn't just a technician; he's a human explosion—loud, boisterous, and entirely focused on getting the job done. As the chief demolitions supervisor for the Bergum Mining Guild, he spent two decades designing and executing the complex blasts that carved the silver from the earth. While he's fundamentally a good guy—known for sharing a raucous laugh and a strong drink—his primary loyalty is to the Guild.

Now, Seamus is absolutely furious that the Apparitions have derailed the Guild's closure of the site. Yes, it was *his* final, brilliant blast that breached the ancient shrine, but he views the ensuing chaos as a costly, embarrassing technical failure, not a supernatural threat. He's here to make things right, not for heroism, but because he's the only one who understands the complex stress points of the mine's structure and can calculate how to safely navigate the compromised tunnels. He joins the Ministry's team with a confident swagger, eager to apply his expertise, seal the source of the haunting, and get the Guild out of Bergum for good.



Blastmaster Seamus

Alchemist 5

Skilled Human

Medium Human Skilled Human Humanoid

Perception +10;

Languages Common, Dwarven, Goblin

Skills Acrobatics +0, Arcana +11, Athletics -2, Crafting +13, Deception +10, Diplomacy +8, Lore: Mining +11, Medicine +12, Nature +10, Society +11, Stealth +7, Survival +10, Thievery +7

Str +0, Dex +2, Con +3, Int +4, Wis +3, Cha +1

Items Hide

AC 22; Fort +12, Ref +11, Will +10

HP 63

Speed 25 feet

Melee Dagger +9 (Agile, Finesse, Thrown 10 ft., Versatile S), Damage 1d4 P

Quick Bomber ◆

No Cause for Alarm ◆◆◆

Fermenting Liquors ◆

Quick Alchemy ◆

Arcane Innate Spells DC 18, attack +8; Cantrips Ignition

Additional Feats Alchemical Crafting, Cooperative Nature, Dragon Spit, Fleet, Magical Crafting, Skilled Human, Smoke Bomb, Terrain Expertise

Additional Specials Advanced Alchemy, Alchemy, Dragon Spit (Produce Flame), Field Benefit (Bomber), Field Discovery (Bomber), Field Vials (Bomber), Formula Book, Formulas (Bomber), Powerful Alchemy, Research Field (Bomber), Skilled Heritage (Deception), Versatile Vials



Inquisitor Giulia

Animist 5

Versatile Human

Detective Giulia is the lead investigator sent by the Ministry of Obscure Affairs, and she is the picture of reserved discipline. She is a woman of deep insight and authority, preferring silent, keen observation to unnecessary conversation. Having dedicated her life to the study of spiritual phenomena and forgotten rituals, she possesses a profound knowledge of the unseen world.

She is constantly accompanied by a ghostly spirit familiar—a small, luminous animal whose form is always in motion, perpetually circling her like a nervous, living shadow. Giulia finds the fear and bluster of the living—especially the loud insistence of locals—to be tedious and inefficient. She speaks languages used only by spirits and shadows, finding the direct, often tragic testimonies of Apparitions far more honest and straightforward than any dialogue with the living. She is here to analyze the disturbance at the ancient shrine and enact whichever precise ritual is necessary to return the spirits to their proper rest.

Medium Human Versatile Human Humanoid

Perception +11; Low-Light Vision

Languages Common, Elven, Necril, Shadowtongue

Skills Acrobatics +7, Athletics +5, Lore: Farming +9, Lore: Fortune-Telling +9, Lore: Herbalism +9, Lore: Underworld +9, Medicine +13, Nature +11, Occultism +11, Religion +11, Society +9, Stealth +10

Str +1, **Dex** +3, **Con** +3, **Int** +2, **Wis** +4, **Cha** +0

Items Padded Armor

AC 21; **Fort** +12, **Ref** +10, **Will** +13

HP 63

Speed 25 feet

Melee Staff +8 (Monk, Two-Hand d8), **Damage** 1d4+1 B

Divine Known Spells DC 21, attack +11; 3rd Veil of Privacy, Safe Passage (1 slots); 2nd Animal Form, Invisibility, Gentle Breeze (1 slots); 1st Harm, Heal, Ill Omen, Protector Tree (1 slots); **Cantrips** Telekinetic Hand, Tangle Vine

Divine Prepared Spells DC 21, attack +11; 3rd ; 2nd ; 1st ; **Cantrips**

Additional Feats Clever Improviser, Embodiment of the Balance, Enhanced Familiar, Gloomseer, Multilingual, Root Magic, Spirit Familiar, Streetwise, Student of the Canon, Untrained Improvisation, Vasodilation, Walk the Wilds

Additional Specials Animist Spellcasting, Animistic Practice (Shaman), Apparition Attunement, Apparition Spellcasting, Invocation of Embodiment (1st), Primary Apparition, Second Apparition, Vessel Spells

Inquisitor Boone

Barbarian 5

Versatile Human

Detective Boone is Detective Giulia's physical opposite—a massive man with an easy smile and a booming laugh that seems entirely out of place in a haunted crypt. He appears outwardly jovial and straightforward, often serving as the team's physical shield, but his true purpose is that of the Ministry's enforcer. Boone is a Duskwalker, a soul deeply tied to the threshold between life and death, which grants him a frightening familiarity with the end of things.

He is built like a wall and possesses raw, intimidating strength, relying on his formidable presence and a massive scythe to control chaotic situations. He speaks the language of the grave and approaches the spectral problem with a shocking lack of hesitation, ready to apply decisive, physical force to anything that manifests in their way. He acts as Giulia's steadfast bodyguard, trusting her esoteric knowledge implicitly, while ensuring no living soul—or overly aggressive apparition—interrupts her quiet work.



Medium	Human	Duskwalker	Humanoid
Perception +10; Low-Light Vision			
Languages Common, Necril			
Skills Acrobatics +2, Athletics +13, Deception +9, Intimidation +11, Lore: Warfare +7, Occultism +7, Thievery +9			
Str +4, Dex +2, Con +4, Int +0, Wis +1, Cha +2			
Items Breastplate			
AC 22; Fort +13, Ref +9, Will +10			
HP 93			
Deliberate Death ➔			
Spiritual Guides ➔			
Willing Death ➔			
Speed 30 feet			
Melee Scythe +13 (Deadly d10, Trip), Damage 1d10+4 S			
Intimidating Strike ⚔			
Rage ⚔			
Quick-Tempered ⚔			
Additional Feats Adrenaline Rush, Assurance, Duskwalker, Intimidating Glare, Lead Climber, Toughness			
Additional Specials Assurance (Intimidation), Furious Footfalls, Instinct (Spirit Instinct)			

